VINTAGE OUTSIDE, FUTURE INSIDE

The iPhone 17e is all about performance over pretence. It might be Apple's most relatable device yet.

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Apple has never been particularly shy about charging flagship prices for non-flagship feelings. The iPhone 17e, to its credit, arrives knowing exactly what it is, the sensible shoes in a wardrobe full of stilettos. We took this one out for a spin and here is everything about it.

Old Bones, New Outfit

The iPhone 17e looks a bit like the old iPhones and it knows it. We for one do not mind, because inside it has a new brain this season that many would love to own. The chunky bezels and classic notch might seem dated but still looks good. For most, it is a perfectly solid slab of metal and glass that still feels very premium in hand.

Bright Enough

The 6.1-inch OLED panel is crisp, colourful and perfectly readable outdoors. Though users get 60Hz refresh rate, we were hoping for a far faster display. Scroll through Instagram next to an iPhone 17 owner and you will notice. Everything else, is a smooth sailing.

A Chip That Overachieves

Here is where the iPhone 17e genuinely earns its keep. The A19 processor is no budget chip masquerading as a workhorse. It handles heavy multitasking, AI apps and even demanding games with composed confidence. The camera, a single 48MP unit, produces warm, well-balanced shots and portrait photos that finally feel intentional rather than apologetic. Low-light performance is solid and 4K Dolby Vision video is genuinely impressive. MagSafe is a welcome addition for the travel crowd.

What We Think?

At ₹84,900 (512GB), the iPhone 17e is a genuinely sensible choice for anyone upgrading from an older iPhone. The performance is excellent, the camera is competent and the battery comfortably survives a demanding day. Yes, there are a few trade-offs, but overall, the package is well built.